thames view
YOUR COMMUNITY MAGAZINE
ISSUE 8
SEPTEMBER 05



CLYDESDALE HOUSE DAMAGED IN FIRE

Early this summer a discarded mattress was set alight in the hallway of Clydesdale House on Kale Road. Over one hundred people were evacuated from the tower block. Seven people were taken to hospital and one person was injured when they jumped from their first floor balcony.

Kathy Keane from Gallions was there when the fire was put out. She ensured all the residents who could return went back in their homes. For those whose homes were too badly damaged Kathy arranged alternative accommodation. Returning to the Gallions' office around 1.30am Kathy then sent out a letter to all Clydesdale House residents. Kathy says:

" Many of the residents on the lower floors were very, very frightened as the smoke was thick, black and choking. It completely filled the block and the biggest cause of concern for everyone was smoke inhalation."

Paramedics, police, fire officers and scene of crime investigators all arrived at Clydesdale House throughout the night and into the early hours of Friday morning. The swift and professional response of the emergency services ensured that what started as a serious fire did not turn in to something much more terrible. The next day the devastation was clear for all to see. As Team Gallions tackled the smoke blackened wall and swept up the debris, residents had to find a way to get back to normal as quickly as possible.

ASBO OBTAINED
Tackling anti-social behaviour

TAVY BRIDGE UPDATE
Keeping you in the picture

ONE TO ONE
Axis brings back apprenticeships

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION



COUNTING THE COST

Several weeks later the full extent of the financial cost of the fire is becoming clear. A first estimate is already running over £100,000. Gallions are doing everything they can to stamp out anti-social behaviour including rubbish dumping. They have a hotline for residents to report problems and are determined to limit nuisance behaviour wherever possible. In this case the damage, distress and disruption caused by the fire could have been avoided if the mattress had not been dumped in the first place.

Team Gallions spend a third of their time just clearing up dumped household rubbish. They do this because it cannot be left lying in the street as it is both a health and fire hazard as seen last month. It costs up to £15,000 a month to do this and it means that there is less time and money for Team Gallions to do the work they are employed to do. In short, everyone loses out if rubbish is dumped in the street.

FLYTIPPERS FINED

Gallions take the problem of fly-tipping very seriously indeed. Dumped rubbish is unsightly and a health hazard. To tackle this problem Gallions is working closely with the local police to identify those guilty of discarding rubbish in Thamesmead's streets. Police will now sift through waste to find evidence of who has been fly-tipping. It is clearly working as Gallions is delighted to report that in conjunction with the London Borough of Greenwich they have issued their first fine for fly-tipping which will cost the guilty party £400. Fly-tipping is inconvenient, unhealthy and expensive.

CHASE THE WASTE

Team Gallions operates a regular Rubbish Amnesty on the first Saturday of every month. This is a free collection service to help you dispose of large items correctly. Simply contact Gallions on freephone 0800 83 84 81 and leave your details. You will be telephoned on the day before *'Rubbish Amnesty Saturday'* and advised when Gallions will be arriving with the van for you to load it up with your discarded items. This service has been launched to help keep your streets clean and safe – just one telephone call would have prevented the fire in Clydesdale House.



RUBBISH AMNESTY 2005

0800 83 84 81

1ST OCTOBER
5TH NOVEMBER
3RD DECEMBER

ISSUE #8

editorial

It has been another summer of sporting activity for the young people of Thamesmead and the parks have played host to many a tournament. However, this summer Gallions has also secured an ASBO. The young man had been causing enormous distress and fear among the community.

At Gallions we want our residents to know that we will take whatever steps we can to prevent anti-social behaviour. Our hotline allows you to leave a confidential message. If you do not report it, we cannot try to resolve it.

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Residents evacuated as smoke fills homes

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What's happening in your area



The Tavy Bridge landscape is changing and Wates is searching for a young photographer to capture the moment.

As part of their Community Day on 14th October, Wates have launched a local photographic competition. Open to residents who are under 16 years of age, prizes will be awarded in two age categories and one for the best photograph overall. A professional photographer will spend a day with all entrants giving them tips and advice on how to take the perfect photograph.

Judges will choose the best of the bunch, pictures will be published and prizes will be given out at the Community Day. If you or your school are interested in taking part please contact the Tavy Bridge Project Office on **0208 310 8820** for more information.

LETTERS

If you have something to say about what's going on in your neighbourhood, why not drop the Thamesview team a line. Send your letters to the Editor, Thamesview, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, SE2. You can also email your thoughts to thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk.

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

September 05

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐

(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

_____

_____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

News Review

Gallions secures youth ASBO

Anti-social behaviour orders (ASBOs) have been used successfully around the country to target a wide range of nuisance behaviour. In August, Gallions obtained an ASBO against a 17 year-old youth who has been terrorising residents of Whinchat Road and the surrounding area. Cases like these are never easy to resolve as understandably, many residents are nervous about coming forward. However, once reassured that we simply needed details of the behaviour they had been subjected to, Gallions was able to gather enough information to take the case forward.

Residents have suffered regular verbal abuse and have been continually harassed and threatened by the youth. Many have felt very intimidated. Taking their stories, together with records of complaints logged about this particular individual, Gallions was able to prove a pattern of disruptive behaviour that was getting worse. The magistrates responded to our case by issuing an Anti-Social Behaviour Order for the maximum term of five years. This is a significant milestone in our drive to stamp out anti-social behaviour and was achieved by residents and Gallions working together to tackle a real problem in the community.

Obtaining this ASBO has shown that we can put a stop to nuisance behaviour. Residents should not have to feel threatened walking around their own neighbourhood. We operate a 'zero tolerance' approach to anti-social behaviour and are determined to tackle it head on. If you have been the victim of anti-social behaviour please contact our hotline. Reporting it may help resolve it.

At Gallions we are committed to making Thamesmead a safe and pleasant environment that everyone can enjoy. We take the problem of anti-social behaviour very seriously indeed. We will take action wherever possible to stamp out problem behaviour.



LEASEHOLDERS LINE

Our weekly leaseholder sessions at the Tenants Resource Centre are your opportunity to come along and discuss any issues or concerns you may have as a homeowner. Please call Yinka Akinyemi or a member of the team on 0208 320 3424 to make an appointment. We no longer run our drop in sessions so do call and make an appointment beforehand.

Community Roundup

It was definitely not the hottest summer on record and it was quite probably one of the wettest but that did not dampen the enthusiasm of Thamesmead's youngsters. Here's just a few of the summer hits of 2005.

Kids stumped

With England doing so well in the Test series it was inevitable that the country would quickly go cricket crazy. Gallions Neighbourhood Wardens were prepared for the rush and bought bats and stumps for the children to use over the summer. Cricket matches were organised and the sound of leather on willow was soon a familiar noise in Thamesmead. The summer ended on a real high for cricket fans when our maintenance contractor Axis (Europe) Ltd handed a Lords Taverners cricket set over to Gallions. With such top of the range equipment now available, surely it is only a matter of time before a young Thamesmead resident is bowling out players and bowling over fans around the world.



Singing (and dancing) in the rain

This summer Gallions teamed up with a local group called The Theatre Street of Performing Arts for a Summer Street Dance School in Crossway Park. Open to youngsters aged between 8 and 16 dance workshops were organised twice a week for 6 weeks. It was very popular with an average of 20 people taking part every session. Everyone agreed that it was good fun and an excellent way to keep fit. You can come and see the Dance School Students perform at Gallions Housing Fair on Saturday 17th September in the Gallions car park.

Just kick it

Once again Charlton Football club delivered an outstanding summer programme. Not only did they provide professional coaches and organise a world cup style tournament, they introduced a series of short 'Healthy Living' workshops. Looking at nutrition, dental care and drugs awareness the coaches talked to the teams every session. They discussed the need for healthy living and how the children could improve their diet and fitness. Sean Daly, project co-ordinator was amazed at how positively the children responded.

"All the children were really interested and became thoroughly involved in the workshops. When we raised the subject of smoking, some of the young people just handed over their cigarettes and lighters. Just hearing how dangerous it is was enough to make them want to stop."

Such has been the success of the project that Sean has plans to roll out the workshop programme to include parents and families.



Gallions Freephone 0800 83 84 81

FUN DAY AT TAVY BRIDGE

The last Saturday in July at the Tavy Bridge Community Hall was the venue for an excellent day out for Tavy Bridge residents. Bouncy castles, balloons, magic tricks and circus acts all helped create a great family atmosphere. With so many stands and activities to choose from there really was something for all age groups. As always the face painter and henna tatooists were very popular. Long queues formed at each stand and the artists worked non-stop throughout the whole event. However, it was well worth the wait just to see the children's faces.



The young dancers of Myztikal once again turned in an amazing performance that really moved the audience. It will come as no surprise to anyone who has seen Myzitkal dance that they stole the show at the national street dancing competition in Hammersmith.

Not to be outdone by the youngsters it wasn't long before mums, dads, grannies and grandads where all up and dancing to the disco. All that jiving was making people hungry and in just 3 hours 400 burgers and sausage rolls were eaten, 800 drinks drunk and endless boxes of crisps and sweets were devoured.



Thanks to everybody who came along and joined in. It was a great day out and we are already looking forward to next year's event!

Birds eye view

The Wates Tavy Bridge team has been out and about listening to what residents want for their neighbourhood – and what you want is more wildlife around the lakes. As part of their Community Day, Wates will install nesting boxes and platforms around Southmere Lake on 14th October. A member of the Royal Society for the Protection of Birds will be there to unveil the boxes and to answer your questions.

Call the Tavy Bridge Project Office on 0208 310 8820 for more information.

help is at hand

This is an exciting time to be a resident in Thamesmead with the regeneration of Tavy Bridge gathering pace. Our Project Office provides a wide range of free and easy to access advice and information services There's a lot on offer, so why not make the most of it.

Maybe you are keen to return to work after some time away or simply want to improve your long-term employment opportunities. Trust Thamesmead's **Building Futures** project might just be right for you. It will give you help and advice about how to develop the right skills for the right job. Our commitment to working closely with our residents is most clearly seen with our neighbourhood wardens. They have quickly become an important part of everyday life in Thamesmead and their range of youth projects are very popular and successful. Please come along and meet our Wardens. They will be happy to talk to you about their role and the range of community schemes they provide.

With the recent changes in the way housing benefit is paid Gallions want to ensure that our residents have easy access to the latest benefit and banking advice. If you have any queries about housing benefit, Social security or Tax credit we will talk it through with you and help identify the best way forward.

The team at the Tavy Bridge Project Office are there to offer you advice and support. They will keep you updated on the regeneration plans and in particular how you and your family will be affected. Just pick up the phone or drop in the office and our staff will be happy to answer your queries.

Update on Stakeholders' Conference

The Tavy Bridge stakeholders' conference in May was very well attended and provided us with some great feedback. It has helped us identify some core work areas and will allow us to focus on such issues as community safety, health and nutrition, affordable childcare and youth facilities. A full report of the event will be available shortly on the Gallions website.

What's happening at the Project Office

Building Futures

Training and employment programme.
Tuesday 10.00 am to 4.00 pm

Benefit and Banking advice.

Let us help you understand the changes to benefit payments.
First Wednesday of month. 10.00 am to 4.00 pm

Tavy Bridge Regeneration.

Project updates, information and support for everyone involved in the regeneration.
Thursday 10.00 am to 4.00 pm

Wardens

Come along and meet our community wardens and find out what plans are in the pipeline and what projects may affect you.
Thursday 3.00pm to 5.00pm

0208 310 8820

HAVE YOUR SAY

Many of our residents like to know what is being done about such issues as crime, vandalism and anti-social behaviour. We have arranged for the police to come along every month and meet with you to discuss your concerns. The next meeting will be held at the Tavy Bridge Community Hall on **16th September from 12.30 to 2.30 pm**. Everybody is welcome and no appointment is necessary – just come along and find out what is happening in your neighbourhood. These meetings are held on the third Friday of every month. Thamesview will keep you updated on the venues and times.

Safety begins at home

You don't have to turn your home into Fort Knox but there are some simple steps you can take to help keep your property and possessions safe.

Lock it up

It may seem obvious but do make sure you close all your windows and doors when going out. Home burglary rates soar over the summer months as thieves take advantage of the hot weather. Back doors left open and windows ajar are invitations to thieves to come in and help themselves. It only takes a few minutes to check everything is locked – it takes a lot longer to replace stolen goods.

Now that you have taken the time to lock up your home, take another few seconds to think where you have left your spare keys. Are the on the table on the hall or hanging near the front door? Well, you had better find a new place for them. Burglars are becoming increasingly crafty and will look through letterboxes and windows to see if house or car keys are within easy reach. If so, they will simply hook them out and use them to walk into your home or drive your car away. It's as easy as that.

Turn it off

And finally, locks and bolts will help keep your home safe but there is one thing they can' t protect against – water damage. Burst pipes however are not the only cause of flooding. If the water has been turned off in your home, do remember to turn off your taps before leaving the house. If water is restored when you are out of the house and the taps are left on, your home may well be flooded. What's more, if you live in a tower block your downstairs neighbours homes will also be flooded.

12 Months Home Contents Insurance from only £3.07 per fortnight.

No Quote Required

Premiums Shown Below

* For tenants aged over 60 premiums start from just £2.23 per fortnight

Pay As You Go Home Contents Insurance

Sum Insured	Fortnightly Cost	Monthly Cost	Annual Cost
£5,000	£2.23	£3.64	£43.68
£8,000	£3.07	£5.48	£65.52
£10,000	£3.35	£6.07	£72.90
£12,000	£3.81	£7.28	£87.36
£15,000	£4.75	£9.10	£109.20
£20,000	£6.15	£12.13	£145.80

- Low cost insurance from only £65.52 (or £43.68 if you are aged over 60)
- Paid fortnightly at any post office, monthly by Direct Debit or annually by cheque/Postal Order – see premiums in the table opposite
- All post codes included at no additional cost
- No security requirements
- No long term commitment – you literally 'pay as you go'

In association with

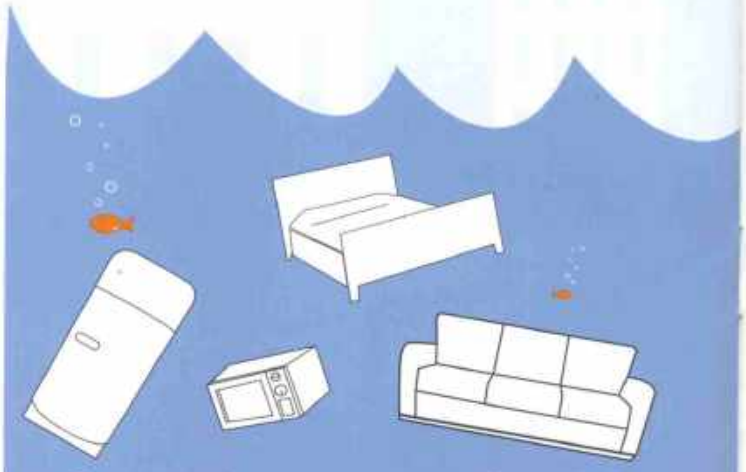
JARDINE LLOYD THOMPSON Tower Risks

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

For more information please call:

0845 4082033

Gallions Freephone 0800 83 84 81



What price peace of mind?

Gallions has arranged a specialist low-cost home contents insurance scheme for our tenants and leaseholders. Home contents insurance provides invaluable peace of mind knowing that you are covered for fire, theft, storm, burst pipes, flood and other risks. All too often we hear stories where residents must find large sums of money to replace damaged goods. The results of an unexpected accident can be devastating and we strongly recommend that all our tenants and leaseholders arrange home contents insurance. Just look what happened to Mr Perry.

"I came home from work one day to find the place flooded. A pipe had burst and ceilings, carpets, furniture and many more of my goods were damaged. I contacted my housing association and they came and repaired the burst pipe and ceiling. But I hadn't taken out contents insurance and was left with a very large bill indeed."

Had Mr Perry arranged contents insurance he would have been able to claim for all the damage caused. As it was he suffered serious financial loss and had to struggle to replace his damaged goods.

To make sure you don't get caught out like Mr Perry, telephone Jardine Lloyd Thompson today on **0845 4082033.**

A small price to pay for a good night's sleep.

one to one

The art of apprenticeships



Apprenticeships have long been the backbone of British industry. Over the years however they seem to have fallen out of fashion with employers and young people alike. Clive Brighton is determined to change all that. Here he tells Joy McKee about his latest drive to train youngsters for the painting and decorating trade.

More than 40 years ago Clive Brighton was a young apprentice learning everything there was to know about painting and decorating. Today, he is responsible for recruiting and running a three-year apprenticeship programme for his employer Axis (Europe) Ltd. Clive joined Axis two years ago bringing with him the belief that for any trade to survive it needs a constant flow of highly trained youngsters following in the footsteps of those retiring. It was an idea fully supported by Axis' Director of Painting and Decorating Joe Ibrahim and between them, Joe and Clive have created an outstanding apprentice scheme. When he heard about the Gallions' graffiti project this summer, Clive came to Thamesmead to see if he could spot any potential young trainees aged between 18 and 22.

"I visit many community schemes and hostels in London," says Clive. "I am not looking for the most talented painter or artist but for those kids who show real enthusiasm. Often many of the young people are doing nothing with their time and just need an opportunity to start them off on the right road."

The Axis apprenticeship programme involves hands on training and a day release to college. It runs for a minimum of two years with an optional third year. Clive always recommends that the apprentices complete the full three years as it gives them a much greater depth of knowledge and understanding.

"We teach our apprentices every single detail of the trade, even down to cleaning their overalls and equipment. By teaching youngsters to take pride in themselves and their work we are ensuring that they deliver a first class service wherever they go."

Clive's traditional work values seem to be becoming increasingly popular as more and more companies realise the crucial role apprentices play in the long-term success of their business. While there is always a job available at Axis for their apprentices Clive believes it is better to work for another company first to broaden their experience.

"A tradesperson can only get better the more experience they have. That's why we recommend that our apprentices 'fly the coop' for a while and then come back to us bringing their skills and experience back to us."

As Gallions' maintenance contractor, Axis has played an important role in Thamesmead driving forward a number of community projects. Shortly, Clive's team of 8 apprentices will be carrying out internal decoration in one of Thamesmead's tower blocks. Residents can see for themselves how Clive's professionalism is put into practice.

WHAT'S AROUND THE CORNER ?

GONE FISHING at a lake near you

While this summer has been about football and cricket for those of you who prefer a more leisurely approach to sport, don't despair. Gallions Warden Phil Briggs is launching a weekly fishing club on Wednesdays at 4pm.

An experienced fisher himself, Phil will teach club members how to set up your rod, cast and land your fish. Don't worry if you are a complete novice, Phil is sure that once you get your first bite you'll be hooked!

Lessons are available to anyone over 8 years of age at a cost of £1 a session. Anyone over 12 years must have a valid fishing licence available at the post office. For more information please call Phil on 0208 320 3431

Back to school

It is not only the young people going back to school this month. Following the success of the last series of training courses, Bexley Adult Education is bringing its Neighbourhood Learning Project back to Thamesmead. Gallions Tenants Resource Centre is the venue for a variety of free classes and courses.



Students from the first term who completed their courses in April all said that although they were nervous at first, they were glad they had signed up. Although learning a new skill is always a bit daunting it is also a lot of fun.

COURSE	DATE	TIME
INTRODUCTION TO WATERCOLOURS	MONDAY 19TH SEPTEMBER	10 - 12
INTRODUCTION TO WATERCOLOURS	MONDAY 19TH SEPTEMBER	1 - 3
COMPUTING LEVEL 1 AND 2	MONDAY 19TH SEPTEMBER	1 - 3
HAIRDRESSING LEVEL 1	TUESDAY20TH SEPTEMBER	1 - 12
PATIO GARDENING (4 WEEKS)	WEDNESDAY 21 SEPTEMBER	10 - 12
FLORISTRY - NCSE QUALIFICATION	FRIDAY 7 OCTOBER	10 – 12

- **GAIN A NCFE PRACTICAL CRAFT SKILLS QUALIFICATION FOR FLORISTRY**
- **FREE 27 WEEK COURSE STARTING ON 7 OCTOBER 2005 10-12NOON.**
- **LIMITED PLACES AVAILABLE – BOOK EARLY**
- **A FREE CRECHE FACILITY IS AVAILABLE ON FRIDAY MORNING COURSES ONLY**

To enrol telephone: Jas Dhillon on 01322 552561 or Linda Woods 0208 320 3468

Gallions Freephone 0800 83 84 81

Dates for your diary

Why not come along to one of our neighbourhood forums and have your say about what's going on in your area.

Monday 10th October

Lesnes, Parkview and Greenmead Forum at The Atrium, 7pm

Monday 17th October

Broadwaters Forum at the Village Hall, 7pm

Thursday 20th October

Southmere Forum at Tavy Bridge Community Hall, 7pm

Monday 24th October

Waterfield Forum at St. Paul's Church, 7pm

Call Wendy Mason or Martin Hogan on 0800 83 84 81 or email getinvolved@gallionsha.co.uk

GALLIONS RESIDENT BOARD ELECTION 2005

The Gallions Residents Board (GRB) is a group of tenants and leaseholders that live in properties owned or managed by Gallions Housing Association. The GRB is elected by residents with the aim of working in partnership with Gallions to improve the quality of life for all residents. They want to make Thamesmead a better place for you to have your home. In this year's June elections the following new members were elected to join the Board.

TENANTS

Isa Laybourne, Abbey Wood

Freda McEwen, Waterfield

Barbara Ramsey, Broadwaters

Dawn Wright, Parkview

LEASEHOLDERS

Alimamy Kargbo, Broadwaters

Sarah Omotola, Mooring

GRB
GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD

ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

For Gallions Residents Board

WILL BE TAKE PLACE ON:

WEDNESDAY 14TH SEPTEMBER 2005 AT 7PM

TENANTS RESOURCE CENTRE (next to Gallions Offices)

Open to all tenants, leaseholders and freeholders refreshments available



Gallions Residents' Board and Gallions Housing Association 6th Annual

housing & community fair

Saturday 17 September 2005 12noon - 4pm

Gallions Housing Association Grounds
Harrow Manor Way
Limited disabled parking



Free BBQ

Free prize draw

win a TV, video, Hi-Fi and kiddie's toys

- Exhibitions
- Stalls
- Bouncy Castle
- Henna Painting
- Face Painting
- Football Games
- Under 5's Play Area
- Children's Entertainers

GRB **Celebrating Diversity in Thamesmead**

Come and meet the people who provide your services
For further information call Martin Hogan on **020 8320 3462**

getinvolved@gallionsha.co.uk

business for neighbourhoods

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

QHS

Contact us

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London
SE2 9XH

For all enquiries please contact the
Customer Response Centre
0800 83 84 81
It's a freephone number that you can use to book services, repairs or for any other enquiries.

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION